

Introductory studies in
SPACEGRASS
Exploring New Acoustic Music

Marcel Ardans
Hayes Griffin

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Exploring New Acoustic Music

Spacegrass is hard to play and harder to notate. I hope this helps.

Transcribed and formatted by Marcel Ardans and Hayes Griffin.

AUTHOR'S NOTE

When Marcel Ardans and I set out to compile this book, our goal was simple: to create a resource that would help guitarists navigate the intricate world of Tony Rice's "spacegrass" era. Tony's work in this style (a blend of hard bop, gypsy jazz, and bluegrass) represents some of the most harmonically rich and melodically adventurous music ever played on an acoustic guitar. However, many players who come from a traditional bluegrass background quickly discover that these tunes are anything but straightforward.

Rather than attempting to transcribe every nuance of Tony's playing, we have assembled a collection of lead sheets that provide clear and playable versions of the melodies and chord changes he used. This book is designed as a "fakebook", a practical reference that allows musicians to understand the harmonic structures and essential phrasing behind these legendary compositions. The goal is to make these tunes accessible to a new generation of players, providing them with a strong foundation for exploration and improvisation.

Between Marcel and myself, we have spent years transcribing Tony's solos and melodies, and this book represents a culmination of that work. While it is by no means a comprehensive collection of all of Tony's spacegrass material, it includes some of the most iconic and requested tunes, such as Manzanita, Gasology, Neon Tetra, and Devlin, among others. We hope this book serves as a valuable tool for guitarists and other instrumentalists who want to study, internalize, and ultimately interpret this music in their own way.

Hayes Griffin

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JOHN REISCHMAN

Dm	E7	A7	Bb6/9	Am7	Gm7
Eo7	Go7	Dm9	F	Dm	Bb7

A

Dm E7 A7 Dm B $\flat$ 6/9 Am7

2 3 4 5

T
A
B

0 0 2 3 2 0 2 4 1 2 0 2 3 2 3 0 1 0 3 6 5 7 5 3

4

6 7 8 9 10 11

Gm7 Dm A7 A7 Dm

1. 2.

TAB

3 5 3 1 3 1 0 3 2 3 0 1 0 3 2 3 2 3 2 3 2 0 0 3 2 0 0 1 0 3 2 3 0 2 3

[illegible]

Gm7 **F**

16 17 18 19

H sl.

TAB 3 1 1 3 1 3 2 3 5 3

E°7 **G°7** **Dm**

20 21 22 23

TAB 5 2 3 2 0 3 0 2 0 3

Gm7 **Bb7** **A7**

24 25 26 27

TAB 0 0 2 3 3 3 2 2

A **Dm** **E7** **A7** **Dm** **Bb6/9** **Am7**

28 29 30 31

TAB 0 4 0 2 3 2 0 2 4 1 2 0 2 3 2 3 0 1 0 3 6 5 7 5 3

Gm7 **Dm** **A7** **Dm**

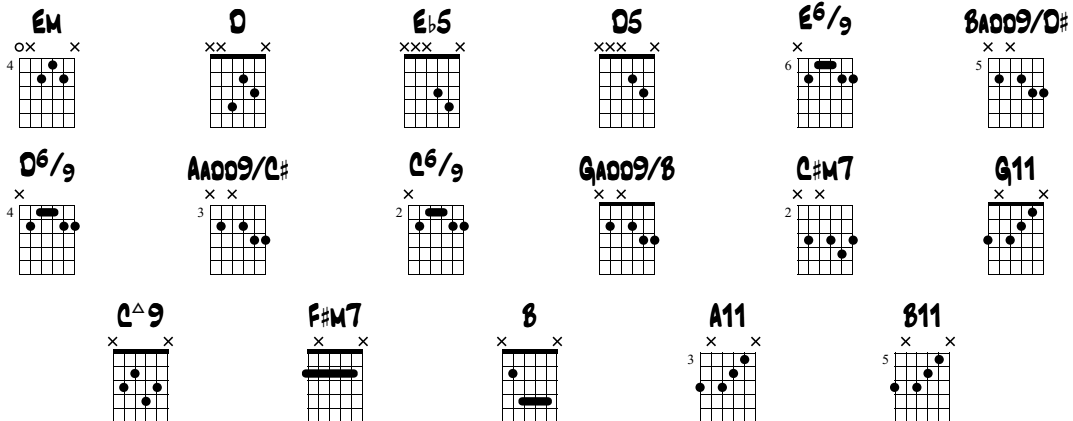
32 33 34 35

TAB 3 5 3 1 3 1 0 3 2 2 3 0 1 0 3 2 3 0 2 3

COMMON GROUND

TONY RICE

TABBED BY ARDANS & GRIFFIN



Standard tuning

VAMP

Em **D** **Eb5** **D5**

A

Eb/9 **Badd9/D#** **D6/9** **Aadd9/C#** **C6/9** **Gadd9/B** **Em** **D**

1. **D** **Em** **Eb5** **D5** **2.** **Em** **D** **Em** **Eb5**

8

C#M7

D⁶/9

G11

C^Δ9

F#M7

18 19 20 21 22

TAB

1.

23 24 25 26 27

TAB

2.

28 29 30 31 32

TAB

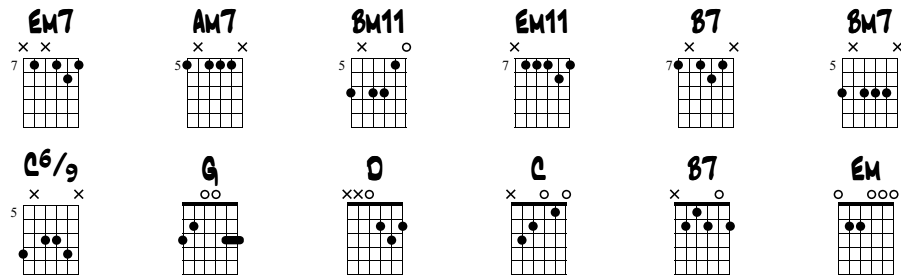
33 34 35 36 37

TAB

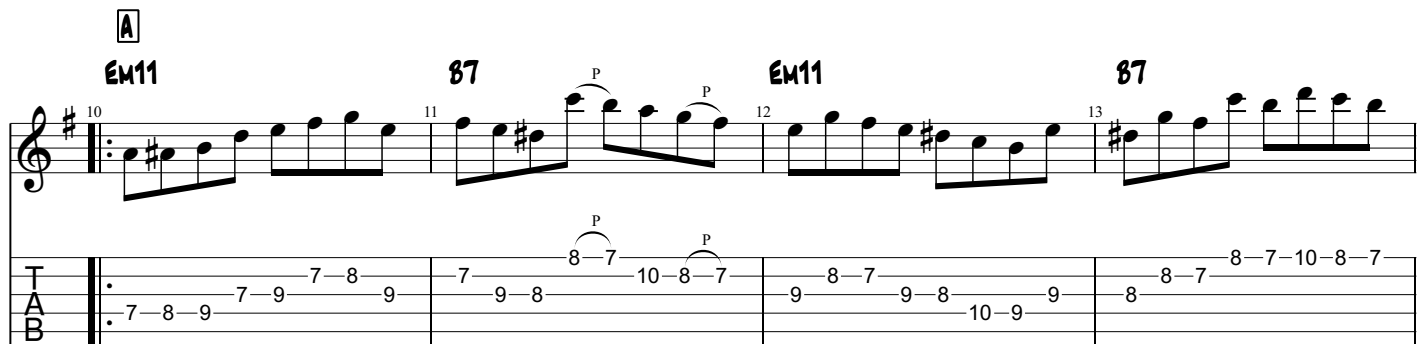
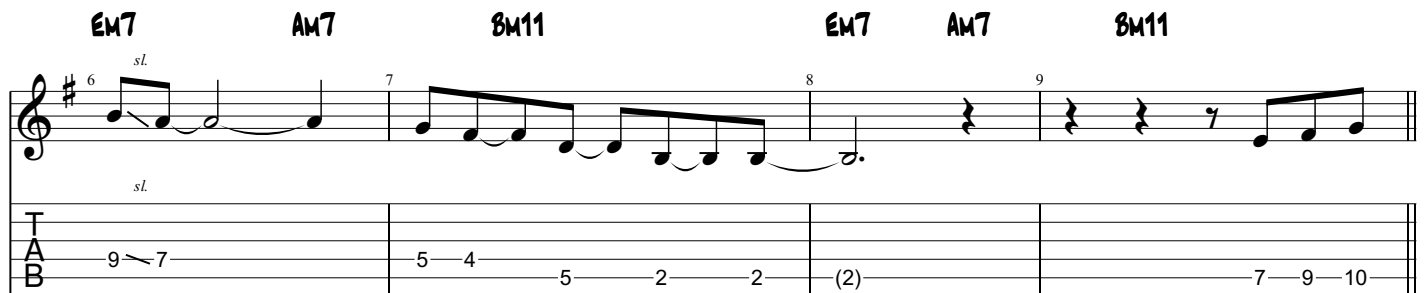
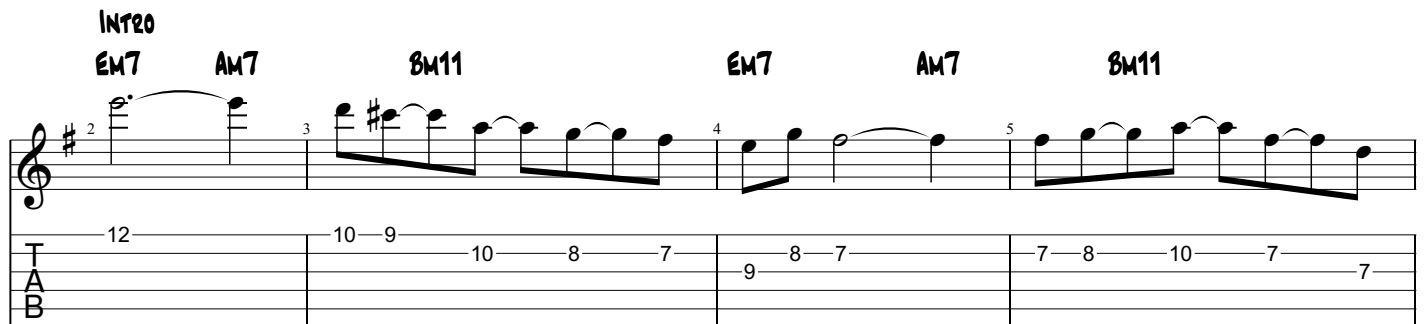
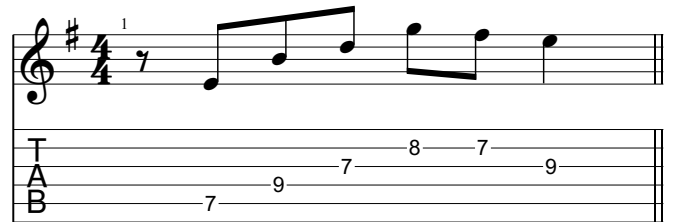
GASOLOGY

TONY RICE

TABBED BY ARDANS & GRIFFIN



Standard tuning



1. 2.

AM7 BM7 C⁶/9 BM7 AM7 BM7 B7 EM11

8

C⁶/9 BM7 AM7 C⁶/9 BM7 EM11

C⁶/9 BM7 AM7 C⁶/9 BM7 EM11

G D C B7 EM

SOLOS

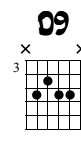
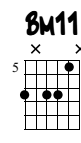
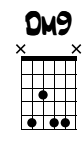
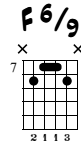
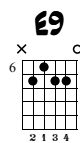
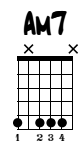
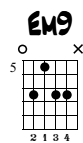
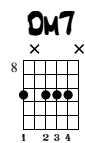
Solo over vamp, then play through A and B parts.

EM7 AM7 BM11 EM7 AM7 BM11

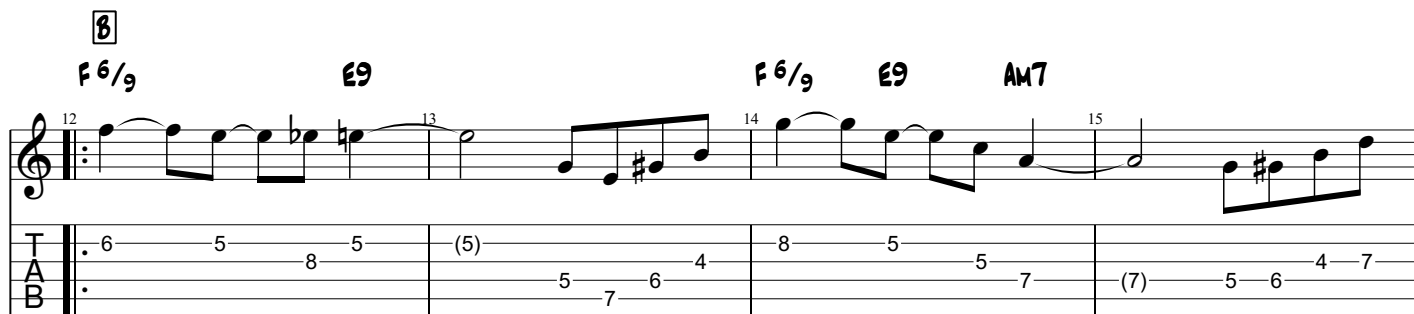
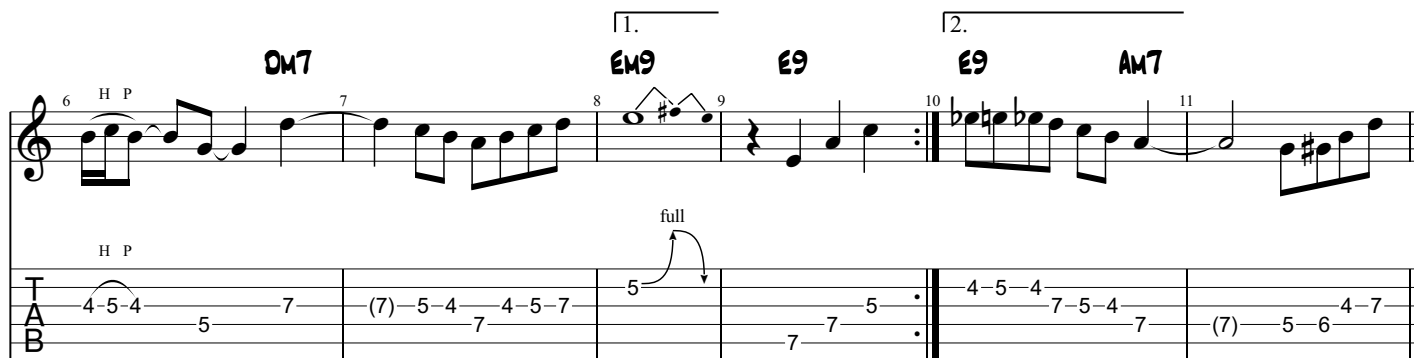
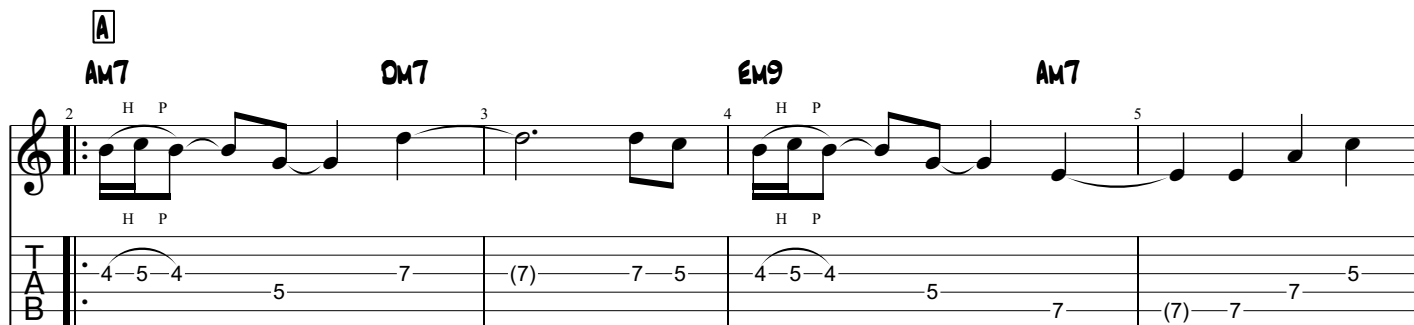
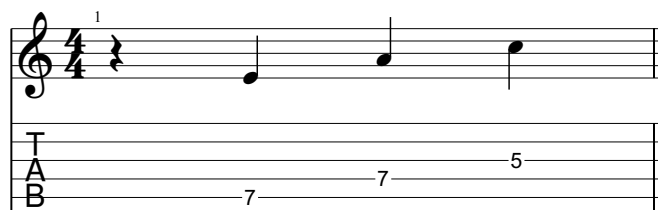
IS THAT SO

TONY RICE

TABBED BY ARDANS & GRIFFIN



Standard tuning



1. 2.

F 6/9

E9

AM7 DM9

EM9

AM7

16 17 18 19 20

TAB

AM7

Bm11

DM9

EM9

AM7

EM9 AM7

21 22 23 24 25 26

TAB

SOLOS

AM7

27 28 29 30

TAB

D9

F 6/9 EM9 AM7

31 32 33 34

TAB

MANZANITA

TONY RICE

TABBED BY ARDANS & GRIFFIN

Csus2



B^bsus2



DM



AM



AM7



D7



F/G



G/A



G/A



F



C



B^b



A7



3 4 2 1

Standard tuning

A

Csus2 B^bsus2 Csus2 DM Csus2

B^bsus2 Csus2 AM AM7 D7

F/G G/A DM AM7 F/G G/A

1. 2.

G/A G/A DM G/A DM

14 15 16

TAB

5 7 5 6 5 7 5 7 0 3 0 7 5 7 5 6 5 0 3 0 1 2

B

F H C DM F P

17 18 19 20

TAB

1 0 2 1 2 0 3 0 1 0 3 0 0 2 3 1 0 3 0

F C

21 22

TAB

1 3 1 2 3 0 2 3 0 2 0 3 2 0 3 0

B $\flat$ A7 DM

23 24 25 26

TAB

1 3 0 3 2 3 0 (0) 0 0 0 2 2 2 0 2 0 3 2 3 0 7 5 7 5 6 5

MAR EAST

TONY RICE

TABBED BY ARDANS & GRIFFIN

F#6/9



A13



G#M7



C#9



E9



EM7b7



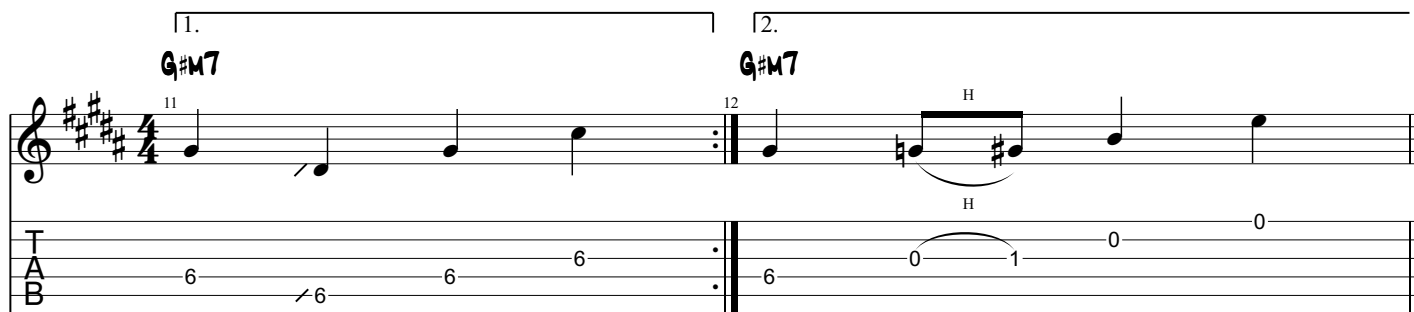
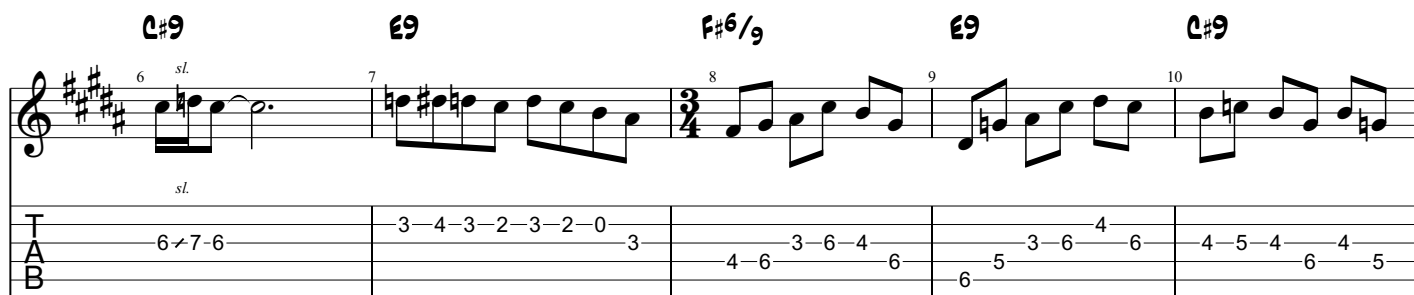
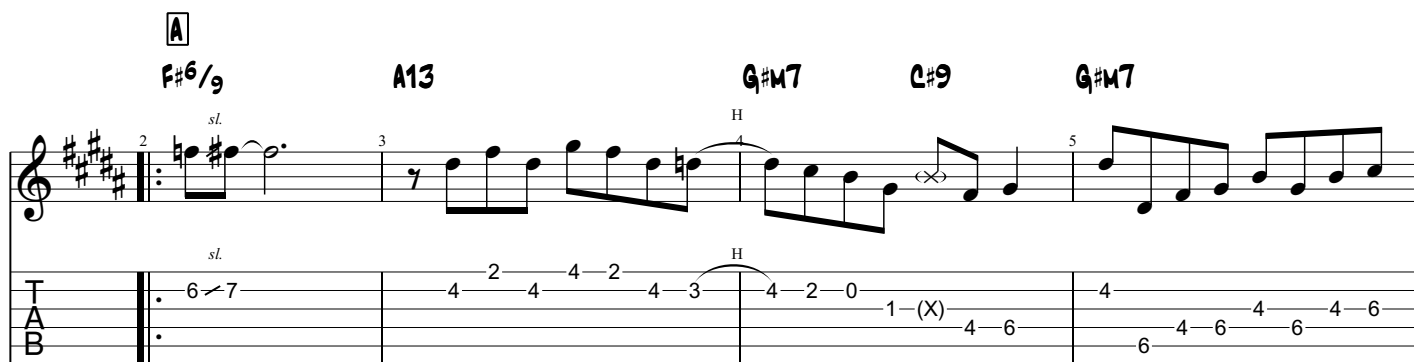
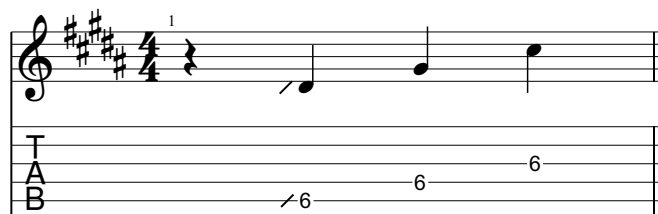
D#M7



D#7



Standard tuning



8

E $\natural$ M $\sharp$ A $\sharp$ 7D $\sharp$ M7G $\sharp$ M7C $\sharp$ 9G $\sharp$ M7C $\sharp$ 9

13 14 15 16 17

TAB

E9

F $\sharp$ 6/9D $\sharp$ 7C $\sharp$ 9G $\sharp$ M7

18 19 20 21 22

TAB

E $\natural$ M $\sharp$ A $\sharp$ 7D $\sharp$ M7G $\sharp$ M7C $\sharp$ 9G $\sharp$ M7C $\sharp$ 9

23 24 25 26 27

TAB

E9

F $\sharp$ 6/9D $\sharp$ 7C $\sharp$ 9G $\sharp$ M7

28 29 30 31 32

TAB

TONY RICE

Bm7 **E9** **A11** **F#11** **G6/9**

The first system of the musical score is for the treble clef. It is in the key of D major (two sharps) and 4/4 time. The melody begins with a quarter rest, followed by a quarter note D4, a quarter note E4, a quarter note F#4, and a quarter note G4. A slur covers the last three notes (F#4, G4, A4), with a 'p' (piano) dynamic marking above the slur. The bass line consists of a whole note chord D4-F#4-A4.

6 7 8 9 10

G^{6/9} **A7** **Bm7** **Bm7**

1. 2.

P

T
A
B

8-7 9-7 9-7-6 9 6-7-9 7-10-7 10 7 10-9-7 9 7 9 7 9-7 7 7

TAG

F#9

E9

G7

F#7

Bm7

11 12 13 14

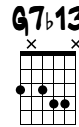
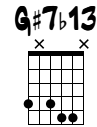
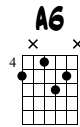
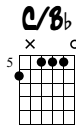
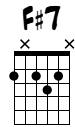
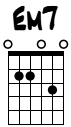
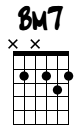
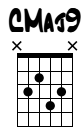
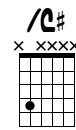
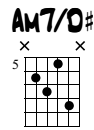
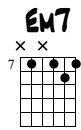
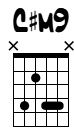
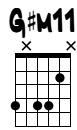
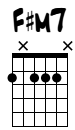
7 5 5 6 7 6 5 7 0

10 9 9 8 9 (9)

NEON TETRA

TONY RICE

TABBED BY ARDANS & BLACK



Standard tuning

INTRO

1.

2.

Chord progression for Intro: F#m7, G#m11, F#m7, G#m11, C#m9, C#m9.

Tablature for Intro, measures 1-5.

A

Chord progression for Section A: F#m7, G#m11, F#m7, G#m11.

Tablature for Section A, measures 6-9.

Chord progression: F#m7, G#m11, F#m7, G#m11.

Tablature for measures 10-13.

Chord progression: Em7, Am7/D#, DMA19, /C#, CMA19, Bm7, Em7.

Tablature for measures 14-17.

8

C#M9 F#7 G#M11 C#M9 F#7 G#M11

TAB

C#M9 F#7 G#M11 C#M9 F#7 G#M11

TAB

C#M9 DMA19

TAB

Em7 Am7/D# DMA19 /C# CMA19 Bm7 C/Bb

TAB

A6 C#M9 CMA19 Bm7 F#M7 G#M11

TAB

A6 **C#M9** **CMA19** **Bm7** **F#M7** **G#7b13** **G7b13**

36 *p* 37 38 *sl* 39

7-5-4 5 4 4-5 0-4 3 2-3-5-2 3 0 3 5 0-0 5 4 0 2

T
A
B

SOLOS

C#M9 **F#7**

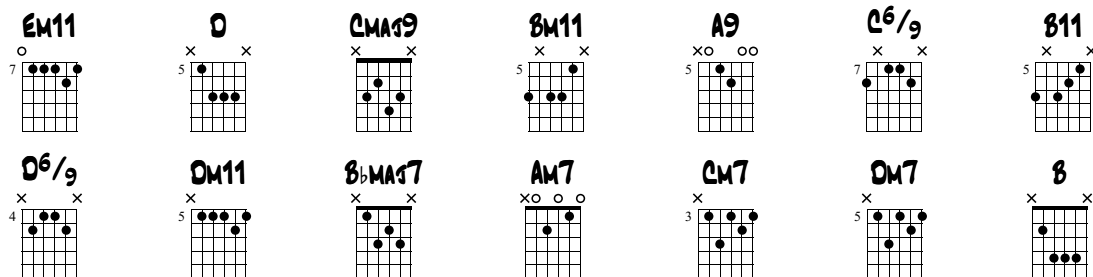
40 41

T
A
B

OLD GRAY COAT

TONY RICE

TABBED BY ARDANS & GRIFFIN



Standard tuning

A

EM11 D CMA19 H P BM11

1 2 3 4 5 6

sl.

H P sl.

TAB

4-0 2-4-0 0-2-0 4-0 2-4-5 5 2-4 5-2 3-0-2-4 0-2-0 4-0 3-7

EM11 A9 C6/9 B11

7 8 9 10

TAB

7 / / / /

EM11 D CMA19 H P BM11

11 12 13 14

P P H P sl.

P H P sl.

TAB

2-4-5 2-4-5 2-5-4-0 2 3-5 2-4 0-2-0 4-0 3-7

A9 A9 D6/9 C6/9 B11

15 16 17 18 19 20 21 22

P sl. sl. P sl.

P sl. P sl.

TAB

7-5 5-4 5 3-5-7 5 (4)-(5) 7+9 9 7-6 7 5-7+9 7-0

8

DM11 **EM11** **BbMA7** **AM7**

23 24 25 26

P

TAB

7 5 7 5 6 5 (5) 8 6 5 7 (7) 5 6 8 5 6 8 5

CM7 **DM7** **CM7** **B**

27 28 29 30

H

TAB

(5) 3 4 6 3 4 6 3 3 5 (5) 3 4 5 3 5 5 7

EM11 **D** **CMa9** **Bm11**

31 32 33 34

H P

TAB

8 7 8 7 9 7 8 10 7 8 10 7 7 7 10 7 5 7 8 7 9 7 9 7

A9

35 36 37 38

H P

sl

TAB

7 9 7 6 7 5 7 9 7

A9 **D6/9** **C6/9** **B11** **EM11**

39 40 41 42 43

sl H P

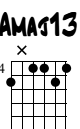
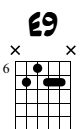
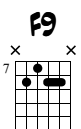
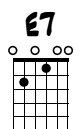
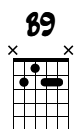
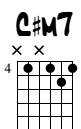
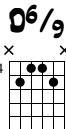
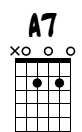
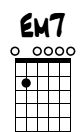
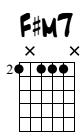
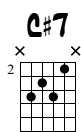
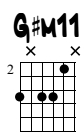
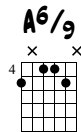
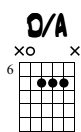
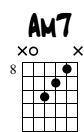
TAB

5 7 5 4 5 4 5 3 0 3 0 2 0 2 0 2 0 3 2 0

PORT TOBACCO

TONY RICE

TABBED BY ARDANS & GRIFFIN



Standard Tuning

[A] IMPROVISE

[1-3]

[4.]

Am7 D/A

1 2 3 4

Am7 D/A

P

P

7 7 7 6 9 6 7

[B]

A6/9

G#m11

C#7

5 6 7 8

P

3

P

3

P

P

9 9 7 9 7 6 7 9 7 7 6 6 7 5 4 4 6 4 7

F#m7

Em7

A7

9 10 11 12

sl.

sl.

7 5 4 2 4 2 4 2 4 2 4 3 0 2 0 0 2 4 0 2 4 1

D6/9

C#m7

F#m7

13 14 15 16

P

P

H

sl.

P

P

H

sl.

2 4 2 3 5 (5) 9 7 6 9 6 7 7 6 7 7 9 (9) 9 9 8 7

89 **E7**

TAB

A6/9 **G#m11** **C#7**

TAB

F#m7 **Em7** **A7**

TAB

D6/9 **C#m7** **F#m7**

TAB

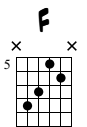
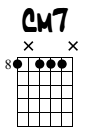
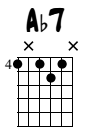
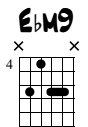
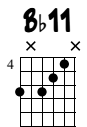
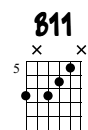
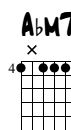
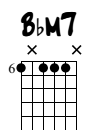
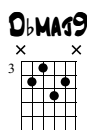
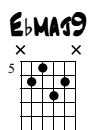
89 **F9** **E9** **A7m13**

TAB

SO MUCH

TONY RICE

TABBED BY ARDANS & GRIFFIN



Standard tuning

A

Chord progression: EbMA19, DbMA19, BMA19, Bbm7

Measure 1: EbMA19 (Notes: Eb, Ab, Bb, C, D)

Measure 2: DbMA19 (Notes: Db, Eb, F, G, Ab)

Measure 3: BMA19 (Notes: B, C, D, Eb, F)

Measure 4: Bbm7 (Notes: Bb, C, D, Eb)

Tab: 5 3 6 4 | 6 6 6 | 4 3 4 3 | 6 4 3 4

Chord progression: Abm7, B11

Measure 5: Abm7 (Notes: Ab, Bb, C, D)

Measure 6: B11 (Notes: B, C, D, Eb, F)

Measure 7: B11 (Notes: B, C, D, Eb, F)

Measure 8: B11 (Notes: B, C, D, Eb, F)

Tab: 6 | 4 6 4 6 8 6 | 8 6 7 9 6 9 | 8 9

Chord progression: EbMA19, DbMA19, BMA19, Bbm7

Measure 9: EbMA19 (Notes: Eb, Ab, Bb, C, D)

Measure 10: DbMA19 (Notes: Db, Eb, F, G, Ab)

Measure 11: BMA19 (Notes: B, C, D, Eb, F)

Measure 12: Bbm7 (Notes: Bb, C, D, Eb)

Tab: 5 3 6 4 | 6 6 6 | 4 3 4 3 | 6 4 3 4

Chord progression: Abm7, B11

Measure 13: Abm7 (Notes: Ab, Bb, C, D)

Measure 14: B11 (Notes: B, C, D, Eb, F)

Measure 15: B11 (Notes: B, C, D, Eb, F)

Measure 16: B11 (Notes: B, C, D, Eb, F)

Tab: 6 6 6 6 6 | 6 6 6 6 6 6 | 6 6 6 6 6 6 | 6 6 4 3 4

Ebm9 **Ab7** **Ebm9** **Ab7**

17 18 19 20

sl. *sl.* *P* *P*

T
A
B

6 4 6 4 6 8 6 8 6 7 6 8 6 8 6 8

Bbm7 **CM7** **F**

21 22 23 24

T
A
B

10 10 10 10 10 10 11 10 8 8 10 10 8 10 8 7 8

Ebm9 **Dbm9** **Bbm7** **Bbm7**

25 26 27 28

sl. *sl.*

T
A
B

6 5 8 6 8 6 8 6 8 4 6 4 6 4 6 3 4 3 4 3 4

Abm7 **Bbm11**

29 30 31 32

1.

T
A
B

6 6 6 6 6 6 6 6 6 6 6 6 6 6 6 4 3 4 6

Ebm9 **Ab7** **Ebm9** **Ab7**

33 34 35 36

sl. *sl.* *P* *P*

T
A
B

6 4 6 4 6 8 6 8 6 7 6 8 6 8 6 8 8

12.

B $\flat$ 11 **E $\flat$ M9** **A $\flat$ 7** **E $\flat$ M9** **A $\flat$ 7**

37 38 39 40 41

T
A
B

6 6 4 3 4 6 6 6 6 4 3 4 6 6 4

E $\flat$ M9 **A $\flat$ 7** **E $\flat$ M9** **A $\flat$ 7**

42 43 44 45

H H sl P P

T
A
B

3 6 4 3 6 4 6 4 6 4 6 8 6 7 6 8 6 8

SWING 51

TONY RICE

TABBED BY ARDANS & GRIFFIN

DMA19



DM9



G13



FMA17



Bb7



A7



Bm7



C6/9



C#M7



F#9



E9



A11



Standard Tuning

A

(Tony's break from David Grisman Quintet)

DMA19 **DM9**

1 2 3 4 5

9 7-10 7-10-9 (9) 7-5 5 7-5 5-7 5 7-5 5 5-4-5 3-5 3-5-8 (8) 5 8 8-7-5-7-(0)

G13 **FMA17** **Bb7**

6 7 8 9

9 7-9 7 7-8-10 (10)-7 7 9-7-9 5 7 5 7-7-9 8 (8) 9 7-5-7-5 7

DMA19 **DM9**

10 11 12 13

4 5 4-6 4 6 5 6-4 5 4-5 3 5 3-5-8 (8) 5 8 8-7-5-7

G13 **A7**

14 15 16 17

T A B

Bm7 **C6/9**

18 19 20 21

T A B

C#m7 **F#9** **Bm7** **E9**

22 23 24 25

T A B

A7 **A11** **A7**

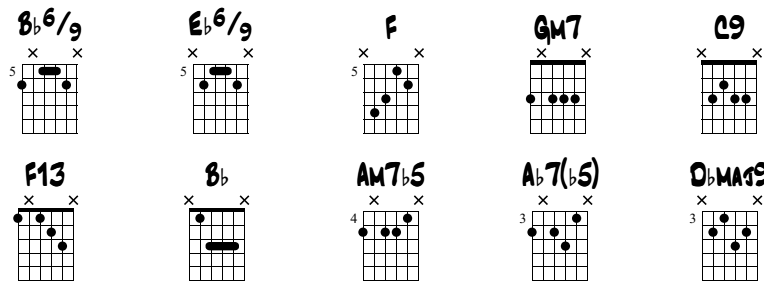
26 27 28 29

T A B

WALTZ FOR INDIRA

TONY RICE

TABBED BY ARDANS & GRIFFIN



Standard tuning

Standard tuning

B $\flat$ 6/9 **E $\flat$ 6/9** **F** **Gm7**

C9 **E $\flat$ 6/9** **F** **B $\flat$ 6/9** **E $\flat$ 6/9**

B $\flat$ 6/9 **E $\flat$ 6/9** **F** **Gm7**

Tablature for the piece, showing measures 1 through 12. The notation includes standard musical notation (treble clef, 3/4 time signature, key signature of two flats) and guitar tablature (TAB). Chord changes are indicated above the staff. Fingering numbers (1-5) are shown below the notes. Slurs and ties are used to indicate phrasing. The word "full" is written above a note in measure 7. The word "sl." is used for slides in measures 4, 11, and 12.

Chords: $E\flat 6/9$ **F13** $B\flat$

Measure 13: Treble clef, key signature of two flats. Notes: B $\flat$ (quarter), A $\flat$ (quarter), G $\flat$ (quarter), F $\flat$ (quarter). Bass clef: 3 (T), 5 (B).

Measure 14: Treble clef: G $\flat$ (quarter), F $\flat$ (quarter), E $\flat$ (quarter), D $\flat$ (quarter). Bass clef: 6 (T), 4 (B).

Measure 15: Treble clef: C $\flat$ (quarter), B $\flat$ (quarter), A $\flat$ (quarter), G $\flat$ (quarter). Bass clef: 3 (T), 5 (B).

Measure 16: Treble clef: F $\flat$ (quarter), E $\flat$ (quarter), D $\flat$ (quarter), C $\flat$ (quarter). Bass clef: 3 (T), 0 (B).

Chords: $A\flat 7(b5)$ $A\flat 7(b5)$ **Gm7** $E\flat 9$

Measure 17: Treble clef: C $\flat$ (quarter), B $\flat$ (quarter), A $\flat$ (quarter), G $\flat$ (quarter). Bass clef: 4 (T), 5 (B).

Measure 18: Treble clef: F $\flat$ (quarter), E $\flat$ (quarter), D $\flat$ (quarter), C $\flat$ (quarter). Bass clef: 3 (T), 6 (B).

Measure 19: Treble clef: B $\flat$ (quarter), A $\flat$ (quarter), G $\flat$ (quarter), F $\flat$ (quarter). Bass clef: 7 (T), 5 (B).

Measure 20: Treble clef: E $\flat$ (quarter), D $\flat$ (quarter), C $\flat$ (quarter), B $\flat$ (quarter). Bass clef: 3 (T), 5 (B).

Chords: $E\flat 6/9$ **F13** $B\flat$

Measure 21: Treble clef: B $\flat$ (quarter), A $\flat$ (quarter), G $\flat$ (quarter), F $\flat$ (quarter). Bass clef: 3 (T), 5 (B).

Measure 22: Treble clef: G $\flat$ (quarter), F $\flat$ (quarter), E $\flat$ (quarter), D $\flat$ (quarter). Bass clef: 6 (T), 3 (B).

Measure 23: Treble clef: C $\flat$ (quarter), B $\flat$ (quarter), A $\flat$ (quarter), G $\flat$ (quarter). Bass clef: 3 (T), 5 (B).

Measure 24: Treble clef: F $\flat$ (quarter), E $\flat$ (quarter), D $\flat$ (quarter), C $\flat$ (quarter). Bass clef: 3 (T), 0 (B).

Chords: $D\flat MA19$ $E\flat 6/9$ **F** **Gm7**

Measure 25: Treble clef: B $\flat$ (quarter), A $\flat$ (quarter), G $\flat$ (quarter), F $\flat$ (quarter). Bass clef: 3 (T), 4 (B).

Measure 26: Treble clef: E $\flat$ (quarter), D $\flat$ (quarter), C $\flat$ (quarter), B $\flat$ (quarter). Bass clef: 4 (T), 4 (B).

Measure 27: Treble clef: G $\flat$ (quarter), F $\flat$ (quarter), E $\flat$ (quarter), D $\flat$ (quarter). Bass clef: 6 (T), 6 (B).

Measure 28: Treble clef: C $\flat$ (quarter), B $\flat$ (quarter), A $\flat$ (quarter), G $\flat$ (quarter). Bass clef: 3 (T), 5 (B).

Chords: $E\flat 6/9$ **F** $B\flat$

Measure 29: Treble clef: B $\flat$ (quarter), A $\flat$ (quarter), G $\flat$ (quarter), F $\flat$ (quarter). Bass clef: 3 (T), 5 (B).

Measure 30: Treble clef: G $\flat$ (quarter), F $\flat$ (quarter), E $\flat$ (quarter), D $\flat$ (quarter). Bass clef: 6 (T), 4 (B).

Measure 31: Treble clef: C $\flat$ (quarter), B $\flat$ (quarter), A $\flat$ (quarter), G $\flat$ (quarter). Bass clef: 3 (T), 5 (B).

Measure 32: Treble clef: F $\flat$ (quarter), E $\flat$ (quarter), D $\flat$ (quarter), C $\flat$ (quarter). Bass clef: 3 (T), 5 (B).